

Strategy : Stakeholders Analysis

Fundamentals of the strategy

What is the goal of this strategy ?

Identify the **stakeholders** of a product in the most exhaustive way possible.

When to use it ?

This analysis should be done **early** in the life cycle of the product in order to avoid forgetting any stakeholder which could be impacted by the software.

Assessment question

Who is impacted by my software ?

What is a stakeholder ?

"**Individuals, groups, organizations, institutions, and societies** that might reasonably be **affected by the technology**" - Value Sensitive Design.

It is **any entity** on which the software can have an impact, **positive** or **negative**, **direct** or **indirect**. A stakeholder can be non-human.

Applying the strategy

The analysis can be performed in 2 steps:

1. **Brainstorm** a range of stakeholders - use the **questions** below to broaden your thinking.
2. Use the **direct vs. indirect** categories to:
 - a. **Categorize** the stakeholders identified in step 1.
 - b. Identify **additional stakeholders**, in particular indirect ones.

Questions for brainstorming

- Who will use your product on a daily basis?
- Who is geographically close to your product or its users?
- Who is socially close to the users of your product?
- Whose activities are created, modified or replaced by your product?
- Who is involved in the maintenance of your product?
- Who provides the services necessary for your product to run?
- Who provides funding?
- Which communities are active in the application domain?

Markkula center questions



Click on me !

Direct vs. Indirect

- **Direct stakeholders** are in contact with the software.
- **Indirect stakeholders** are impacted by the existence of the software although they do not directly interact with it. Identifying these stakeholders is particularly useful to **anticipate non-obvious adverse impacts** of your software

Examples are given on the diagram on the right side.

Note: the boundary between the two categories is not always very clear-cut.

